

**States won
\$206 billion for
children's health.**

3.5%

is what reached prevention. Where the rest went is stranger than you think.

THE FINDING

The 1998 tobacco settlement, this year.

Collected by states a year  \$22.1bn

Spent on prevention  \$764.8m

Campaign for Tobacco-Free Kids, FY2025 state report.

WHAT IT MEANS

The 27th consecutive year the promise has been broken.

The money was pledged to health, and especially to children's health. It went almost everywhere else.

IT GETS STRANGE

\$36 billion of it was sold to Wall Street.

States turned future payments into upfront bonds to plug budget holes. Washington took \$450 million upfront. Its tobacco money went on to pay investors \$848 million.

IT GETS STRANGER

The money grew tobacco.

North Carolina spent settlement money on tobacco curing barns and a processing plant. Health money, farming the harm.

IT GETS STRANGEST

37 attorneys general filed in court FOR Philip Morris.

The payments scale with cigarette sales, and state budgets had come to depend on them. So in 2003 the states defended the defendant.

The count is the New England Journal of Medicine's.

TO BE FAIR

The promise can be written into the contract.

The opioid settlements proved it: a binding 85 percent earmark for treatment, written into the terms. Tobacco's failure was a drafting choice, not a law of nature.

FOLLOW THE MONEY, CONTINUED

Which contract did 47 states just sign with Meta?

That is Part 4, tomorrow. Sources in the comments. If this landed, repost it. The families this money was promised to deserve to know where it went.

The Guided Digital Childhood, guidedchildhood.com